

MACDONALD KUGWA

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Authorized to work in the U.S. | Open to remote or hybrid | W-2 or Corp-to-Corp | Available for on-call rotation

CYBERSECURITY ANALYST | SECURITY OPERATIONS (SOC) | INCIDENT RESPONSE & ENDPOINT SECURITY

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

CompTIA CySA+ certified cybersecurity analyst with hands-on daily responsibility for security monitoring, alert triage, and incident response across a 50+ site enterprise environment. Triage CrowStrike Falcon EDR detections, investigates phishing reports, malware alerts, and suspicious authentication activity in Microsoft Entra ID, executes containment under documented procedure, and maintains audit-ready incident documentation. Authors the SOPs, runbooks, and knowledge base articles the wider support team operates from. Builds and hardens Linux infrastructure in a personal lab, applying least-privilege, network segmentation, and defense-in-depth. Backed by 18+ years of enterprise IT and help desk experience, including 24/7 on-call rotation. B.S. in Computer Science.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Security Monitoring & Event Analysis | Alert Triage & Escalation | Incident Response (Identification, Containment, Eradication, Recovery) | Endpoint Detection & Response (EDR) | Phishing & Email Threat Investigation | Malware Detection Handling | Suspicious Login & Identity Anomaly Analysis | Log Analysis | Evidence Handling & Incident Documentation | Ticket Creation, Routing & Closure | SOPs, Runbooks, Playbooks & Knowledge Articles | Security Metrics & Reporting | Vulnerability & Patch Remediation Tracking | Security Control Implementation & Validation | Alert Tuning & False-Positive Reduction | Identity & Access Management | Endpoint Hardening | Zero Trust, Least Privilege & Defense-in-Depth | MITRE ATT&CK Concepts | Risk, Audit & Compliance Evidence Support | Security Awareness Support | Windows & Linux | Networking & Firewall Fundamentals | Cloud & Hybrid Identity (Microsoft 365, Entra ID) | ITIL-Aligned Incident, Problem & Change Management | 24/7 On-Call Rotation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Analyst — Security Operations & Service Desk (Contract) May 2026 – Present

ByteScale Systems LLC (Owner/Consultant) — client: USA DeBusk LLC, Houston, TX

- Monitor and analyze security events across endpoint, identity, email, and network platforms for a 50+ site enterprise, performing initial triage of CrowStrike Falcon EDR detections and escalating per defined incident response procedure.
- Investigate endpoint alerts, phishing reports, malware detections, and suspicious sign-in activity in Microsoft Entra ID; gather evidence, validate observations, and follow established escalation paths.
- Execute containment actions under documented procedure — account disablement, session revocation, forced credential resets, and device isolation — and manage identity lifecycle in Entra ID including provisioning, MFA enrollment, and access review.
- Analyze Falcon detection telemetry, endpoint process activity, and sign-in logs to validate alerts, reconstruct incident timelines, and separate true positives from noise.
- Document incident details, investigative steps, and resolution actions in Freshservice to a compliance- and audit-ready standard; ranked #1 in resolution volume across all ticket categories for two consecutive months.
- Author and maintain SOPs, runbooks, checklists, and knowledge articles covering endpoint enrollment, access provisioning, onboarding, and incident handling — ensuring consistent alert and incident handling across the team.
- Prepare recurring operational reports, metrics, and summaries for IT leadership, translating technical detail into decision-ready language.
- Collaborate with infrastructure, application, and business stakeholders to remediate findings and strengthen overall security posture; supply ticket detail and evidence supporting audit and compliance requests.
- Reinforce security awareness across the user base — answering employee security questions, guiding safe practices, and reporting recurring gaps to leadership.
- Administer FortiSASE secure access and web filtering policy; assist with configuration and validation of security controls across endpoints, identity systems, and network access.
- Track endpoint patch and compliance posture through Microsoft Intune, prioritizing remediation across the managed device fleet and following findings through to closure.
- Identify recurring alert patterns and false positives, recommending tuning that reduces noise and improves signal for the team.
- Participate in on-call rotation supporting 24/7 industrial operations, responding to after-hours and weekend escalations.

Cybersecurity & IT Consultant (Contract) Feb 2021 – Present

Infomes Tech Consulting — Houston, TX

- Deliver cybersecurity, fraud detection, and IT risk consulting to small and mid-sized clients across six service lines, including a dedicated healthcare IT practice.

- Assess client environments for security gaps and misconfigurations, and recommend endpoint hardening, access control, and monitoring improvements.

AI Evaluation Specialist (Contract)2020 – Present

Outlier / Alignerr / Mercor — Remote

- Develop Gold Standard evaluation rubrics and structured test criteria for assessing model output against defined safety and quality standards.

Technical Support SpecialistJan 2024 – Jan 2025

ADT Security Services

- Diagnosed and resolved hardware, software, and connectivity issues for residential and commercial security systems in a high-volume support environment.

Technical Support / Client Care Professional2007 – Dec 2020

Bell Mobility (Rogers Communications)

- Supported enterprise and consumer users on network, device, and billing-platform applications over a 13-year tenure, consistently meeting quality and resolution metrics.
- Served as an escalation point for complex technical issues, partnering with engineering teams to close root-cause gaps.

SECURITY LAB & HANDS-ON PROJECTS

Self-Directed Linux & Infrastructure Security Lab2026 – Present

Ubuntu / KVM / libvirt virtualization environment; dual-boot Windows 11 / Ubuntu 24.04 workstation with Kali Linux VM

- Built and hardened a multi-VM Ubuntu Server environment on a KVM/libvirt hypervisor, provisioning segmented database and application tiers with SSH access control.
- Applied defense-in-depth and network segmentation: UFW host firewalls with explicit allow rules, restricting the database listener to accept connections only from the application server's address.
- Implemented least-privilege access — provisioned a scoped database service account limited to read/write with no schema or administrative rights.
- Designed and deployed a working three-tier architecture (client to Node.js/Express API to SQL Server backend), validating end-to-end connectivity and access control at each layer.

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA Cybersecurity Analyst (CySA+) — DoD 8570/8140 approved
- Splunk Core Certified User
- Cisco Network Defense
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science2025

University of the People

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT (IN PROGRESS)

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate
- Security+, ISC2 CC or SSCP, Microsoft SC-200; NIST CSF / CIS Controls familiarity; vulnerability scanner exposure (Nessus, Qualys, Tenable); TryHackMe / LetsDefend / Blue Team Level 1 completions]

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Tools (production use): CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR), FortiSASE, Microsoft Entra ID (Conditional Access, MFA), Microsoft Intune, Microsoft 365, Active Directory

Certified / Training Environment: Splunk (SIEM search, dashboards, reporting)

Practices: Security monitoring & alert triage, incident response lifecycle, log analysis, identity & access management, endpoint hardening, patch & vulnerability compliance, incident documentation, root cause analysis, ITIL-aligned incident/problem/change management (Freshservice)

Platforms: Windows 10/11 & Server, Ubuntu Server 22.04/24.04, Kali Linux, KVM/libvirt virtualization, macOS, iOS/Android

Other: SQL Server administration, UFW/host firewalls, SSH hardening, Node.js/Express, Bash & cron scripting, Excel (advanced reporting & reconciliation)